Youtube link for Challenge 5:https://youtu.be/zjQ8qhUCmJg?si=B5LUd5uUORDH1Jpi

THINK TANK INVESTOR PITCH

From Classroom to Farm Enterprise

A $10,000 grant proposal to equip Bugesera youth with practical agricultural skills, entrepreneurship training, and a pathway to employment.

Mission statement

“Our think tank mission is to bridge the gap between education and employment in Bugesera by transforming theoretical learning into practical agricultural skills.”

Ask: $10,000

To launch a pilot Youth Agribusiness Training & Incubation Program with partner-supported field exposure and business coaching.

Our mission addresses a real market gap

Bugesera already has an agricultural base. The missing link is practical, job-ready capability.

Mission statement

“Bridge the gap between education and employment in Bugesera by transforming theoretical learning into practical agricultural skills.”

This mission is strategic because it connects three things investors care about: employability, productivity, and local economic opportunity.

59.4%

of Bugesera households are engaged in crop farming

38.8%

of youth 16–30 in Bugesera are neither in employment nor in education or training

56.2%

national youth labour underutilization in Rwanda (2024)

The bridge we are building

Education today

Too much theory, not enough hands-on agricultural practice.

Our intervention

Practical training + business skills + incubation support.

Economic outcome

Youth become more employable, productive, and enterprise-ready.

Problem statement: education and the labour market are disconnected

The opportunity exists in Bugesera agriculture, but too many young people are not prepared to capture it.

Problem statement

Bugesera has a high number of unemployed and inactive youth because formal education remains heavily theoretical, while the local economy needs practical agricultural, technical, and entrepreneurial skills. As a result, graduates struggle to find work and local agricultural productivity stays below its potential.

Why this matters to investors

The district already has a strong agricultural base to build on.

The youth challenge is not only access to school — it is readiness for work.

A practical pilot can convert existing potential into measurable outcomes.

What causes the gap?

- Theory-heavy learning
- Limited resources & exposure
- Weak entrepreneurship skills

Result

Youth remain unemployed, inactive, or underprepared while agriculture remains less productive than it could be.

38.8%
Bugesera youth NEET

59.4%
households in crop farming

$0
impact unless skills are applied

Research evidence: the gap is practical, not motivational

Our field observation and interview insight point to a very specific bottleneck.

What we heard in the field

AgriWIN interview insight

Young people are interested in agriculture, but they often do not know how to run it as a real business. They need exposure to crop management, irrigation, planning, markets, and enterprise thinking — not theory alone.

This insight is important because it tells us the solution is not just more information. It is a structured practical experience that combines technical training with business execution.

What our research tells us to solve

Practical gap	Graduates lack field exposure to real farming systems and productivity methods.
Business gap	Many youth do not know how to price, plan, market, or manage an agribusiness.
Access gap	Capital, mentorship, and market linkages are still too hard for first-time agripreneurs.

Conclusion: the winning intervention is hands-on agribusiness training with incubation support.

Solution statement: launch a Youth Agribusiness Training & Incubation Program

We will use the grant to convert theory into practical capability, then practical capability into enterprise readiness.

Solution statement

In partnership with institutions such as RICA and Bridge2Rwanda farms, we will deliver hands-on agricultural training, entrepreneurship skills, and market linkages so that youth can treat agriculture as a profitable enterprise instead of a last-resort activity.

Program design

1. Hands-on training

Crop management, irrigation basics, farm operations, and real field practice.

2. Incubation program

3 months bootcamp for 30 selected Agripreneurs to refine their Agribusiness ideas. They transform their concepts into viable and market-ready ventures .

3. Market linkage

Mentorship, exposure visits, final pitching, and support for top youth teams.

Pilot targets (proposed)

60 youth
trained in a structured pilot cycle

12 weeks
of technical + business learning

2 partner sites
for practical exposure and demonstration

1 final showcase
to connect top teams to mentors and supporters

How we will use the $10,000

This budget is designed to maximize direct value to youth participants while keeping the pilot execution-ready.

Training plot, seeds, tools & irrigation starter inputs Direct practical learning materials for the cohort	**$3,200**
Trainers, mentors & partner-led workshops Specialist instruction and field coaching	**$2,200**
Entrepreneurship bootcamp & market linkage activities Business model, pricing, and market-readiness training	**$1,500**
Mini incubation starter packs for top youth teams Early-stage support for pilot agribusiness teams	**$1,400**
Transport, coordination & exposure visits Access to partner sites and smooth delivery	**$900**
Monitoring, evaluation & final demo day Track outcomes and showcase the strongest ventures	**$800**

Who the money serves

60 youth participants

will receive practical and business training during the pilot.

Top 10 teams

will receive starter support, mentorship, and final showcase visibility.

Partner-supported delivery

means the grant is leveraged through practical exposure, coaching, and accountability.

TOTAL BUDGET: $10,000 Each line item is directly tied to delivery, participant value, or measurement.

Expected impact and execution roadmap

We are proposing a pilot that can be tracked, evaluated, and improved — not an abstract idea.

60 youth

complete practical and business-oriented training

5 teams

receive incubation support and showcase-ready business concepts

2 sites

anchor partner-led field exposure and demonstration learning

1 system

for tracking completion, venture quality, and follow-up outcomes

12-month roadmap

Phase 1

Recruit cohort
Confirm partners
Prepare inputs

Phase 2

Deliver hands-on agriculture training

Phase 3

Run enterprise skills and incubation support

Phase 4

Demo day
Measure outcomes
Plan scale-up

Why we deserve this grant

We are offering investors a locally grounded, evidence-based, and execution-focused pilot.

- ✓ We understand the problem from both research and field engagement.
- ✓ Our solution is practical, not theoretical — it combines skills, enterprise, and exposure.
- ✓ The budget is disciplined and tied directly to participant value.
- ✓ The pilot is measurable, partnership-ready, and built to attract future support.

Thank you